

Therapeutic Communication

QUESTION ONE

- A. Differentiate between open-ended and closed-ended questions, providing two examples of each.

(5 Marks)

- B. List FIVE (5) situations in which closed-ended questions are most appropriate to use.

(5 Marks)

- C. Discuss the role of constructive criticism in workplace environments.

(5 Marks)

- D. Elaborate on how constructive criticism can be integrated into improvement strategies to aid employees in setting and achieving their work goals.

(5 Marks)

(Total 20 Marks)

Answer

- A. Differentiate between open-ended and closed-ended questions, providing two examples of each.

Answer: Open-ended questions invite detailed answers, while closed-ended questions typically require a single-word or short response.

Open-ended questions encourage elaboration and do not have a predetermined set of responses.

Examples: “How do you feel about the new policy?”, “What are your goals for this project?”

Closed-ended questions have a limited number of possible answers, often “yes” or “no”, or a multiple-choice selection.

Examples: “Did you complete the task?”, “Is the report finished?”

- B. List FIVE (5) situations in which closed-ended questions are most appropriate to use

Answer: Closed-ended questions are most appropriate for data collection, confirmation, and efficiency.

When collecting specific, quantifiable data (e.g., age, frequency).

When confirming a fact or decision (e.g., “Did you agree to this?”).

When a quick, definitive answer is needed in an urgent situation.

When surveying a large audience for statistical analysis.

When a limited range of options is available and needs selection.

- C. Discuss the role of constructive criticism in workplace environments.

Answer: Constructive criticism plays a vital role in professional development, performance improvement, and fostering a culture of open communication.

It provides specific, actionable feedback that helps employees understand areas for improvement.

It supports professional growth by highlighting strengths and offering guidance on skill development.

It helps align individual performance with organizational goals and standards.

It builds trust and transparency when delivered respectfully and fairly.

It is a key tool for effective management and team collaboration.

D. Elaborate on how constructive criticism can be integrated into improvement strategies to aid employees in setting and achieving their work goals.

Answer: Constructive criticism can be integrated into improvement strategies by linking feedback directly to goal setting and providing ongoing support.

Goal Alignment: Use feedback sessions to connect specific criticism to existing goals or help set new, relevant goals.

Action Planning: Collaborate with employees to create concrete, step-by-step action plans based on the feedback.

Regular Check-ins: Schedule frequent follow-ups to monitor progress, provide support, and adjust strategies as needed.

Training & Resources: Offer necessary training, mentorship, or resources to address the areas highlighted by the criticism.

Recognition of Progress: Acknowledge and celebrate improvements and achievements along the way to maintain motivation.